

2023 年初赛试题

(Total: 150 marks Time: 120 minutes)

Part I Listening Comprehension (30 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

In this section, you will hear **five** short conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, one question will be asked, and you have **fifteen seconds** to read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.

1.



A.



B.



C.



D.

2. A. Undergraduate parking allowed. B. Postgraduate parking allowed.
C. Only staff parking allowed. D. No student parking allowed.
3. A. I will be more efficient to get the work done.
B. The project is so complicated.
C. They can make good use of their advantages.
D. It will be much better to collaborate.
4. A. A geological sample. B. Some unknown fish.
C. Some samples of a rare plant. D. Several amazing rocks.
5. A. The teachers are inadequately prepared. B. It has remained the same for too long.
C. Pupils no longer find it enjoyable. D. It is not sufficiently varied.

Section B (10 marks)

In this section, you will hear **two** long conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, there will be a **one-minute** pause. During the pause, read the questions and make your answers on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the center.

Conversation One

Listen to the conversation. Then read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer according to what you hear. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.

6. What is Mark going to briefly talk about?
A. Promotion of new products. B. A new strategy for pricing.
C. Management of large companies. D. A suggestion for setting sales targets.
7. According to the woman, air tickets are cheapest if _____.
A. they are for weekends travel B. they are booked well in advance
C. they are non-refundable D. they are for group travel



8. What does Mark think revenue management is?
- A. It's interesting. B. It's complicated.
C. It's reasonable. D. It's time-consuming.
9. The airline companies' revenue management is intended to _____.
A. attract more passengers B. fly more airplanes
C. improve their service D. benefit the passengers
10. What are two reasons for the new approach to pricing?
A. Marketing policies and law changes.
B. Law changes and computer programs.
C. Needs analysis and computer programs.
D. Computer programs and marketing policies.

Conversation Two

*Listen to the conversation, and complete the following sentences with **one word** according to what you hear. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

11. The arguments are supported by _____ in this version of Alex's essay.
12. Alex read some other essays and tried to use a similar _____ for the structure.
13. There are too many _____ points of view in Alex's essay.
14. The professor suggests that Alex's paragraphs should be _____.
15. In academic books, paragraphs are occasionally much too _____.

Section C (5 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **five** short news items. Each item will be read only **once**. After each item, there will be a **fifteen-second** pause. During the pause, read the question and the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

16. How many artificial intelligence talents will China demand by 2025?
A. 5 million. B. 10 million.
C. 25 million. D. 30 million.
17. Why will the Paris 2024 Olympic Games choose Phrygian caps as mascots?
A. They have a prominent place in French society.
B. They are a symbol of revolution and freedom, of striving.
C. They can be seen everywhere in France.
D. They reflect the artists' unique personification.
18. Which of the following **isn't true** of the 2023 national postgraduate entrance exam?
A. Test-takers were 170,000 more than last year.
B. 4.74 million test-takers took part in the entrance exam.
C. The annual increase of 3.7 percent was considered the lowest in years.
D. More students chose less famous universities instead of well-known ones.
19. What has been found about giraffes in the news item?
A. China has more giraffes than any other country.
B. Female giraffes usually live longer than male ones.
C. Their strong skull and strong neck bones help them get food.
D. Their long necks are helpful for competitions between males.

20. What is the aim of Africa's Great Green Wall?

- A. To offer more jobs for the local people.
- B. To build an 8,000-kilometer-long forest.
- C. To improve the environment in the local area.
- D. To fulfil the task the United Nations has assigned.

Section D (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear one monologue. The monologue will be read **twice**. After listening, answer the questions using **not more than five words**. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

21. What do the engravings show in Namibia?

22. What is the single largest problem faced by people who manage the sites?

23. When you go to a site, how can you learn things?

24. Why can't you camp on a site if you go on your own?

25. What is prohibited when you enjoy the rock art on the field trip?

Part II Vocabulary & Grammar (15 marks)

*There are **15** incomplete sentences in this part. For each blank there are **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**. Choose the one that best completes the sentence. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

26. It is important to set yourself clear _____ so you know what you are aiming for.

- A. objects
- B. goals
- C. decisions
- D. opportunities

27. He decided to buy a really expensive painting by a famous Renaissance painter and not a(n) _____.

- A. imitation
- B. adaption
- C. production
- D. composition

28. The man was put into an isolation ward because the disease was highly _____.

- A. infectious
- B. destructive
- C. severe
- D. massive

29. My first job was to arrange the files into _____ order from the oldest to the most recent.

- A. alphabetical
- B. chronological
- C. numerical
- D. historical

30. Realizing that raising citizens' cultural confidence plays a vital role, the government has taken a series of measures to build more museums and make them more _____ to the public.

- A. reasonable
- B. responsible
- C. applicable
- D. accessible

31. The government should do more to help the _____ to find a job.

- A. denied
- B. excessive
- C. unemployed
- D. insecure

32. My new fridge has a little screen on the outside that _____ the internal and external temperature.

- A. displays
- B. designs
- C. devises
- D. discovers

33. _____, I believe that banning smokers from public places is a very good idea.

- A. Clearly
- B. Fortunately
- C. Justifiably
- D. Personally

34. Dina asked the hotel receptionist to give her a wake-up call; _____, she overslept and missed her fight.

- A. therefore
- B. consequently
- C. nevertheless
- D. likewise

35. When I surf the Internet I often _____. Before I know it, quite a few hours have gone by.
 A. take my time B. lose track of time
 C. control time D. make poor use of time
36. Let's wait until the music _____ before we announce the big news.
 A. dies down B. cuts down C. sets down D. closes down
37. This is the third year _____ that a female has been chosen to manage the club.
 A. in procession B. in success C. in process D. in succession
38. It can take _____ time for people to get used to the new system.
 A. long B. a long C. so long D. too long
39. —_____ You look a bit like you need a vacation.
 —Actually, I think I just need to sleep for a week. I've been studying way too hard.
 —You should take a week off and go lie on a beach somewhere!
 A. Where did you go last weekend?
 B. How is your study going?
 C. How was your day trip to the Great Wall?
 D. Why did you stay up late last night?
40. —My doctor has suggested that I try music therapy to reduce my pain.
 —Really? _____
 —At the hospital or at a private clinic.
 A. Do you think music therapy will work?
 B. Who does music therapy for you?
 C. Where can you get music therapy?
 D. How come you believe in music therapy?



Part III Cloze (10 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in the blanks with the correct forms of 5 words out of the 7 given in the box. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

rather than slow require run out manufacture rapid turn on



CO₂ plays a critical role in maintaining the balance in the Earth's atmosphere and the air that we breathe. It is also a waste product of the fossil fuels that almost every person on the planet uses for transport and other energy (41) _____. Because we create CO₂ every time we drive a car, cook a meal or turn on a light, and because the gas lasts around a century in the atmosphere, the proportion of CO₂ in the atmosphere is (42) _____ increasing.

The best evidence indicates that we need to reduce CO₂ emissions by 70 percent by 2050. If you own a four-wheel-drive car and replace it with a hybrid car, or a smaller standard-fuel car, you can achieve a reduction of that magnitude in a day, (43) _____ half a century. Unfortunately our past history of change is considerably slower than this. Samuel Bowser first invented the petrol pump in 1885 but it wasn't until 1988 that all new cars (44) _____ in the UK were required to use unleaded petrol only.

Not only do fossil fuels pose an environmental hazard but there is also a pressing need

to find an alternative energy source that is renewable. Opinions as to how much oil remains vary considerably. Some say that the Earth has produced only 18 per cent of its potential yield of oil; others say supplies may (45) _____ as early as 2015. Many countries are exploring alternative energy sources such as solar energy or wind power.

Section B (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in each blank with **one** word in one of the following **three** ways: according to the context, by using the correct form of the given word, or by using the given letter (s) of the word. Remember to write the answers on the **answer sheet**.



"Leisure activity isn't just for fun," says a University of Florida (UF) psychologist who has developed a scale that classifies hobbies based on needs they satisfy in people. The scale can help people find more personal (46) _____ (fulfil) by giving them insight into what they really like. "The surprising thing is that activities you might think are very different have similar effects (47) _____ people," said Howard E.A. Tinsley, a UF psychology professor who developed the measurement. "Probably no one would consider acting to have the same characteristics as roller-skating or playing baseball, but men and women who act as a hobby report feeling an intense sense of (48) be _____ to a group, much the same way others do in playing sports."

And activities providing the (49) _____ (strong) sense of competition are not sports, but card, arcade and computer games, he found. Participating in soccer satisfies our desire for a sense of team, and coin collecting and baking fulfil our need for "creativity". "With so many people in jobs they don't care for, leisure is a prized aspect of people's lives," Tinsley said. "Yet it's not something psychologists really study. Economists tell us how much money people spend skiing, but nobody explains why skiing really appeals to people. Or how one activity relates to another, perhaps in (50) _____ (expect) ways," Tinsley said. "Fishing, generally considered more of an outdoor recreational activity, for example, is a form of self-expression like stamp collecting, because it gives people the opportunity to express some aspect of their personality by doing something completely different from their daily routine," he said.



Part IV Reading Comprehension (30 marks)

Read the following passages. Each passage is followed by several questions. Respond to the questions using information from the passage. Remember to write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

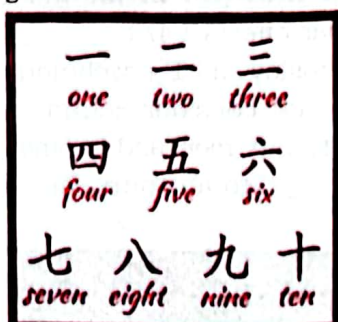
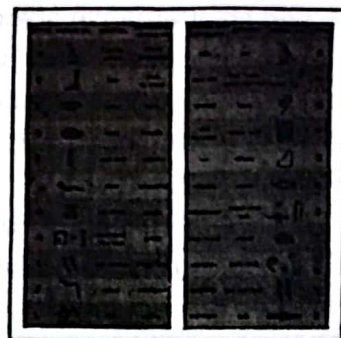
Section A (10 marks)

Questions 51–55 are based on the following passage.

One of the first skills a child will learn upon entering school is how to write their names and the other alphabet letters. It is a learned skill that requires knowledge of work, fine motor skills(精细动作), and memory. (51) _____ However, writing didn't always exist in

alphabet form as we know it today. In fact, there was a time when it didn't exist at all.

(52) _____ Hieroglyphics looked like pictures. Some pictures would represent objects. For example, if the word was a bird, then the picture would be a bird. These are called pictograms. However, hieroglyphics weren't limited to pictograms. Some pictures could represent a sound. For example, in some cases, a picture of a bird functioned as the sound "a". It was a very complicated form of writing. There are totally more than 700 pictures or symbols—many more than the 26 letters in the English alphabet. In addition, there was no punctuation. To make things more difficult, hieroglyphics could be written from left to right, right to left, or even from top to bottom. Because hieroglyphic writing had such a complex written form, it took many years of practice to master it. Most Egyptians at that time couldn't read or write. Writing was a highly learned skill that only the government writers or the priests knew how to do it.



Like the ancient Egyptians, the ancient Chinese also developed a writing system based on pictograms from around the period of 1500 BC. Like some hieroglyphics, the first Chinese characters looked like the word they were meant to represent. For example, the word sun was a visual image of the sun. Also, like hieroglyphics, the Chinese characters weren't limited to pictograms. Other characters were created to represent concepts. They didn't necessarily look like the word itself. In fact, many characters are a combination of two or more characters. For example, the character combination of sun and moon means bright. In this way, each character combination has a unique meaning. Chinese speakers had to learn characters from thousands of unique pictures to be able to read and write the language. This makes Chinese one of the most difficult languages even today. The form of the pictograms used in ancient Chinese writing has changed and now only makes up a small percentage of the Chinese characters. (53) _____

Pictograms, like those used in ancient Egyptian and Chinese writing, are still used in today's world. For example, anywhere you may travel, a sign that shows a simple figure of a man or woman is sufficient to communicate which restroom is for women and which is for men. In addition, you can find no-smoking pictograms almost anywhere you go. (54) _____ These are used to communicate feelings or other thoughts.

Though the invention of writing started with the use of pictograms, hieroglyphics aren't written in Egypt anymore and ancient Chinese pictograms have changed. In addition, writing has evolved and most modern languages now use an alphabet system. (55) _____

Questions 51–55

Choose from the sentences A–G the one which best fits each gap of 51–55. There are two



extra sentences which you do not need to use.

- A. Still, pictograms remain the most form of written language communication and are still in use today.
- B. Writing is the act or skill of putting words or ideas down for others to read.
- C. The ancient Egyptians created hieroglyphics, the first form of writing, around 3500 BC.
- D. These days, young people are also making more use of pictograms in emails and text messages in the form of emojis.
- E. However, it is still considered one of the longest-lasting writing systems that exists today because of its ancient roots.
- F. The invention of writing came from a need to keep track of information, history, and money.
- G. Along with reading, it is one of the most basic skills needed for all academics.

Section B (10 marks)

Questions 56–60 are based on the following passage.

Throughout history, people have thought of the ocean as diverse and limitless source of food. Yet today there are clear signs that the oceans have a limit. Most of the big fish in our oceans are now gone. One major factor is overfishing. People are taking so many fish from the sea that species cannot replace themselves. How did this problem start? And what is the future for fish?

Source of the Problem

For centuries, local fishermen caught only enough fish for themselves and their communities. However, in the mid-20th century, people around the world became interested in making protein-rich foods, such as fish, cheaper and more available. In response to this, governments gave money and other help to the fishing industry.

As a result, the fishing industry grew. Large commercial fishing companies began catching enormous quantities of fish for profit and selling them to worldwide markets. They started using new fishing technologies that made fishing easier. These technologies included sonar to locate fish, and dragging large nets along the ocean floor. Modern technology allows commercial fishermen to catch many more fish than local fishermen can.

Rise of the Little Fish

In 2003, a scientific report estimated that only 10 percent remained of the large ocean fish populations that existed before commercial fishing began. Specifically, commercial fishing has greatly reduced the number of large predatory(捕食性的) fish, such as cod and tuna. Today, there are plenty of fish in the sea, but they're mostly just the little ones. Small fish, such as sardines and anchovies, have more than doubled in number—largely because there are not enough big fish to eat them.

This trend is a problem because ecosystems need predators to be stable. Predators are necessary to weed out sick and weak individuals. Without this weeding out, or survival of the fittest, ecosystems become less stable. As a result, fish are less able to survive difficulties such as pollution, environmental change, or changes in the food supply.

A Future for Fish?

A study published in 2006 in the journal *Science* made a prediction: If we continue to

overfish the oceans, most of the fish that we catch now—from tuna to sardines—will largely disappear by 2050. However, the researchers say we can prevent this situation if we restore the ocean's biodiversity.

Scientists say there are a few ways we can do this. First, commercial fishing companies need to catch fewer fish. This will increase the number of large predatory fish. Another way to improve the biodiversity of the oceans is to develop aquaculture—fish farming. Growing fish on farms means we can rely less on wild-caught fish. This gives species the opportunities to restore themselves. In addition, we can make good choices about what we eat. For example, we can stop eating the fish that are most in danger. If we are careful today, we can still look forward to a future with fish.

Questions 56–60

Answer the following questions with the information given in the passage.

56. What mainly accounts for the disappearance of most of the big fish in the oceans?
57. Why can commercial fishing companies catch more fish than local fishermen can?
58. What do ocean ecosystems need to remain stable?
59. What might happen by 2050 if fishing continues at the current rate?
60. How can we restore the ocean's biodiversity?

Section C (10 marks)

Questions 61–65 are based on the following passage.

A life without cars would be hard for most people to imagine. Karl Benz invented the modern car in 1879. About a hundred years later, cars had become available in nearly every country. In the US, 95 percent of all families have at least one car. In fact, driving a car is an important stage toward becoming an adult for US teenagers. At the age of 16 or 18, many teenagers will attend driving schools and get their driver's license; it is their ticket to freedom.



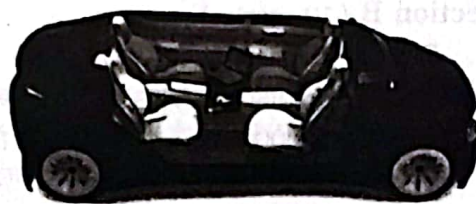
Cars are now making steps toward their own kind of freedom: that is, freedom from people. The desire to make a self-driving car began in the 1930s. However, it is not easy to build the technology for a self-driving car that is not only intelligent but also safe. Sensors, GPS, computer programs—these are all technologies a self-driving car needs to be able to



drive on roads. The goal is to build the car to have artificial intelligence so that it thinks and drives like a human. First, the car should know where it is. Second the car should be able to sense people, other cars, and objects around it. Third, the car should be able to predict what a nearby person or object might do next. Then it must be able to respond accordingly by adjusting its speed or moving away from the object.

In recent years, the technology for a self-driving car has reached the point for testing on public roads. In fact, Google began testing its self-driving car in 2009. In addition, the state of Nevada issued the first license for a driverless car in 2012. As of 2017, more than a dozen US states allow for self-driving cars to be tested on public roads, and Google's self-driving cars have already driven more than 1.5 million miles.

Public opinion of self-driving cars is mixed at best. A self-driving car has clear advantages. For example, riding in a car would no longer be limited by age or ability. A child under the age of 16 would be able to ride in a self-driving car alone with no need for a license. A blind person could rely on a self-



driving car to go from one place to another. In addition, most crashes are due to people making mistakes. Many accidents are caused by such problems as people using the phone while driving, falling asleep, or driving while drunk to name a few. With a self-driving car, people would not need to worry about such situations on the road.

However, there are also serious concerns when it comes to self-driving cars. First, the technology is still far from perfect. A self-driving car relies only on its sensors, GPS, and computer programs to work properly. If any of these were to break or be used for purposes other than they are intended, the safety and security of the rider as well as other people on the road could be put at risk. Drivers may not trust or want to give up complete control to a self-driving car. Another concern is that self-driving cars will probably be too expensive to the average family to afford. In addition, there would be a serious loss of most driving-related jobs. Finally, some drivers see driving as more than just a means to get from one place to another. Driving brings a sense of freedom and pleasure that many drivers might not want to let go of. Self-driving cars look to be a part of the near future, but how much of a role they will play can only be determined by time.

Questions 61–65

Complete the summary below with information from the passage, using **no more than three words for each blank**.

As life improves, cars have been available nearly in every family. In recent years, especially, by using artificial intelligence, that is, sensors, GPS and (61) _____, self-driving cars have begun to spring up. Riding in a car is no longer limited by (62) _____, and it can also avoid many accidents caused by people's mistaken behaviors. However, every coin has two sides. The technology of self-driving hasn't come to perfection. The (63) _____ on the rider and other people on the road will be threatened if the technologies are used (64) _____. And self-driving cars also lead to a serious loss of most driving-related jobs, and drivers lose a sense of (65) _____. Good or not, the time will tell.

Part V Translation (15 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into Chinese. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

66. Nowadays we often hear the word "sustainable" being used a great deal in academic journals and periodicals. Environmentalists in particular insist that any development should be sustainable. They argue that sustainable practices have great benefits for us and can have a significant impact on the future of our planet. However, the word "sustainable" needs to be clearly defined. Sustainable development consists in exploiting our natural resources without destroying them.

Section B (10 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into English. Write the answer on the **answer sheet**.

67. 中国是公认的四大文明古国之一，其有记载的历史和文化可以追溯到5000年前。中国的饮食历史、茶传统、诗歌和艺术、医药、戏剧和节日只是中国丰富的文化多样性的众多方面中的一部分。对于中国这样一个历史悠久的国家来说，不同地区的民族和习俗差异巨大是很自然的。无论走到哪儿，你都会体验到传统、习俗和遗产的独特结合。



Part VI IQ Test (10 marks)

There are **five** IQ Test questions in this part. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

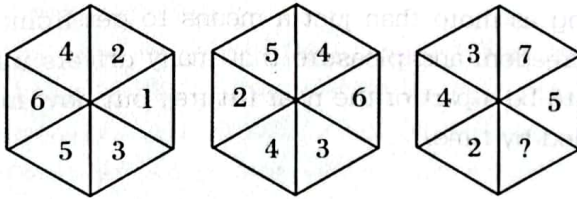
68. Do you really think we can sell our cars in Japan? It's like carrying coals to Newcastle.

What is the Chinese meaning of the underlined phrase?

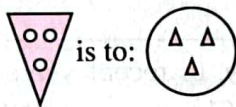
69. Which word in brackets is most opposite in meaning to the word in capitals?

INDIGENT (rich, peaceful, eager, powerful)

70. What number should replace the question mark?



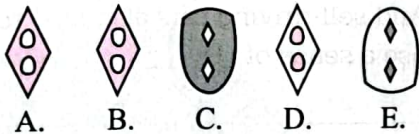
- 71.



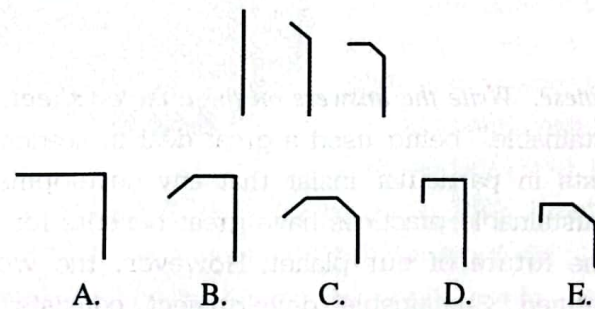
as



is to:



72. Which option below continues the given sequence?



Part VII Error Correction (10 marks)

There are ten errors altogether in the following passage. The errors are: missing words, unnecessary words and wrong words. Please correct them as follows: for a missing word, mark its position with a symbol “^” and write it; for an unnecessary word, cross it out with the symbol “\”; for a wrong word, underline it and write the correct word. An example of how to correct the error is provided below. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

For example:

One of my favourite writers are Charlotte Brontë . She was born in the early _____ is
nineteenth century when women had far fewer opportunities ^ they have now. than
She lived in a small village in Yorkshire and she took great pleasure in walking
on the moors where near her home. where

When radio took off in the 1920s, its effect was revolutionary. Yet a few
years early, when Marconi was working on transmitting messages from 73. _____
the land to ships at sea, history recorded his sense of disappointing at the fact 74. _____
that the messages could be picked anywhere. He had envisioned something
similar to a privately telephone conversation, only over a wireless network. 75. _____

At first, there was no plan in place for broadcast radio, but its popularity
booms. People no longer had to go out to hear music or wait days to hear news. 76. _____
Radio was both entertaining and informed and, although the advent of cinema 77. _____
and television brief threatened its existence, radio adapted and prospered 78. _____
alongside the new developments. Even today, many million of listeners 79. _____
remain very fond the medium. 80. _____

To a large extent, the Internet now covers our need to be informed,
entertained and in a contact with one another, so the survival of radio 81. _____
in its present form is by any means guaranteed. 82. _____

Part VIII Writing (30 marks)

Section A (10 marks)

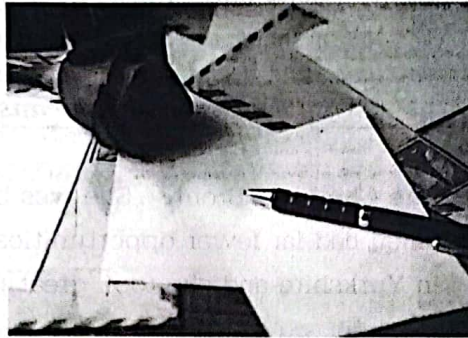
83. All jobs can be stressful, but some jobs are much more stressful than others. Below are some high- and low-stress jobs in America, along with their annual median salaries.

HIGH- AND LOW-STRESS JOBS			
6 MOST STRESSFUL JOBS		6 LEAST STRESSFUL JOBS	
1  Military Personnel \$41,998	4  Newspaper Reporter \$36,000	1  University Professor \$62,050	4  Dietician \$53,250
2  Firefighter \$45,250	5  Taxi Driver \$22,440	2  Seamstress/ Tailor \$25,850	5  Hair stylist \$22,500
3  Commercial Airline Pilot \$92,060	6  Police Officer \$55,010	3  Jeweler \$35,170	6  Librarian \$54,500

Write a report in 80—100 words based on the information above.

Section B (20 marks)

84. Nowadays a lot of people find it difficult to write letters and even think it unnecessary to write letters. Letter writing is a dying art.



*What is your view on this? Write an essay in at least **120** words on the **answer sheet**.*

2023 年决赛试题

(Total: 150 marks Time: 120 minutes)

Part I Listening Comprehension (30 marks)

微信扫描，听力音频

In this section, you will hear **five** short conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, one question will be asked, and you have **fifteen seconds** to read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.

1. A. His luggage got lost.
C. He doesn't have travel insurance.
2. A. The salary.
C. The working hours.
3. A. Swimming is the best way to exercise.
B. Hiking is as boring as swimming.
C. Swimming can make people more excited than hiking.
D. Hiking isn't suitable for people who want to exercise regularly.
4. A. He wrote letters and searched through trash cans.
B. He was interested in making money.
C. He spent most of the money on stamps.
D. He was good at collecting and organizing.
5. A. Women take longer to recover after training hard.
B. It's more important for women runners to consider dieting.
C. Running is becoming more popular with women than men.
D. Women runners' endurance isn't any better than men runners'.



In this section, you will hear **two** long conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, there will be a **one-minute** pause. During the pause, read the questions and make your answers on the answer sheet with a single line through the center.

*Listen to the conversation. Then read the **four** choices marked A, B, C and D, and decide which is the best answer according to what you hear. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

6. What made Jessica interested in social media at first?
 - A. The fact that young people everywhere used these sites every day.
 - B. How much her niece had used social media.
 - C. How big the social media industry had become.
 - D. The fact that using social media had made her feel depressed.
7. What question did the University of Utah researchers ask the students?
 - A. How many online friends they had.
 - B. Why they used social media sites.

- C. How much time they spent on a popular social media site.
 - D. Why they had grown so heavily dependent on the Internet.
8. What do many people tend to do according to the University of Utah study?
- A. Show great curiosity about how other people live.
 - B. Jump to conclusions based on limited knowledge.
 - C. Care a lot about what other people think of them.
 - D. Share their joys and sorrows in real life online.
9. What do users of social media sites usually do?
- A. Share their photos with friends and family.
 - B. Try to show off the best bits of their life.
 - C. Create an honest image of themselves online.
 - D. Make complaints about social injustices.
10. Who are most negatively affected by social media sites?
- A. Those who have the fewest friends online.
 - B. Those who often make comments on others' profiles.
 - C. Those who rarely update their own profiles.
 - D. Those who take no interest in social activities.

Conversation Two

*Listen to the conversation, and complete the following sentences with **one word** according to what you hear. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

- 11. Studies show that if your name is nearer to the _____ of the alphabet, you are more successful.
- 12. People whose first name contains more than five letters make about \$ _____ less in salary per letter.
- 13. One study shows that students who spell their names in a _____ way probably will not become successful.
- 14. One reason why women become leaders less often is because they have fewer _____.
- 15. Ann thinks she'd have to become less gentler and more _____ for people to give her a chance as a female leader.

Section C (5 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **five** short news items. Each item will be read only **once**. After each item, there will be a **fifteen-second** pause. During the pause, read the question and the **four** choices marked **A**, **B**, **C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

16. What is the normal amount of rain in Brazil's North coast in the whole month of February?
- A. 24 centimeters.
 - B. 30 centimeters.
 - C. 36 centimeters.
 - D. 60 centimeters.
17. What do we learn from the news item?
- A. An unusual protein has been found to be linked with Alzheimer's disease.
 - B. American scientists have discovered a new medicine to cure Alzheimer's.
 - C. A blood test kit for Alzheimer's diagnosis is officially approved in Japan.
 - D. Brain imaging has proved more reliable than blood tests in treating Alzheimer's.
18. What problem have Africans faced according to the news item?
- A. Severe air pollution.
 - B. Lack of basic drinking water.
 - C. Shortage of medicine and doctors.
 - D. Poor infrastructure.

19. Why does the use of tobacco in Kenya increase?
- Anti-tobacco policies are not strictly enforced.
 - The government hasn't taken effective measures.
 - The WHO hasn't provided necessary aid.
 - Alternative tobacco products haven't been banned.
20. What happened to the man in the news item?
- He came across a snowstorm and got lost on his way home.
 - He survived a serious car accident but had a leg broken.
 - He was stuck in a snow-covered car for two months but survived.
 - He carried on a study on how to stay alive in extremely low temperatures.

Section D (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear one monologue. The monologue will be read **twice**. After listening, answer the questions using **not more than five words**. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

- What assignment does the professor want his students to complete?
- What percentage of Botswana's total population now live in urban areas?
- What are some of the problems Botswana's overpopulated capital city is now facing?
- Why has the professor recommended certain websites?
- What should students use to support their conclusions?

Part II Vocabulary & Grammar (15 marks)

*There are **15** incomplete sentences in this part. For each blank there are **four** choices marked **A**, **B**, **C** and **D**. Choose the one that best completes the sentence. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

- That book has a lot of _____. I found it hard to put down.
A. suspense B. novel C. perfection D. evolution
- A great _____ surrounded the diamond, because two different people claimed that they were the owner.
A. competition B. prediction C. dishonesty D. controversy
- You should know that you are not _____! If you are not good at your job, the company will fire you.
A. indifferent B. unnecessary C. unpredictable D. indispensable
- She is usually so _____, so it was quite a surprise when she bought two tickets without a second thought.
A. unexpected B. unfamiliar C. indecisive D. informal
- Someday we will completely _____ such diseases as cancer and heart disease.
A. wipe B. conquer C. sweep D. finish
- The number of visitors to our website this year has already _____ last year's total number of visitors.
A. survived B. suppressed C. surpassed D. sustained
- Liz is _____ on food so that she doesn't have to go grocery shopping for the next few weeks.
A. stocking up B. shopping around C. doing without D. cutting down
- The website has a great video showing the inside of the pyramid. It's like _____ being there!
A. approximately B. probably C. naturally D. virtually
- I'm _____ the world, because I just found out that I got a promotion.
A. all around B. on top of C. out of D. at the heart of

35. Ricky owes money _____ everybody and has to repay his loans. He is so much _____ debt.
 A. to; in B. for; in C. by; on D. to; on
36. We left home an hour earlier than we needed to _____ our fear of finding traffic.
 A. with regard to B. due to C. in spite of D. regardless of
37. Life without a constant supply of water can be difficult, _____.
 A. that is to say B. to say the least
 C. it's hard to say D. when all is said and done
38. —Why don't you give Jack some advice?
 —Oh no, that's a situation I definitely want to _____.
 A. stay out of B. bring up C. put up with D. break down
39. —Stress can affect both your mental and physical health, so you should do something to reduce it. Exercising helps a lot. _____.
 —Unfortunately, Dr. Jones, I do neither of them. I work too much.
 —Well, you need to start looking after yourself.
 A. Have you ever been to pubs?
 B. Where do you usually exercise?
 C. She goes to the gym every weekend.
 D. Do you go to the gym or play any sports?
40. —Let's grab a bite to eat before we go to Science class.
 —No, I'm really overweight and I can't take it anymore.
 —You should increase the amount of exercise you get. _____.
 —It had crossed my mind, but the last time I lifted weights, I pulled a muscle in my back.
 —That's because you didn't warm up.
 A. Come to the gym with me.
 B. Let's have a coffee in the afternoon.
 C. It's a good way to keep fit.
 D. Why don't you go to the hospital and have a check?

Part III Cloze (10 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in the blanks with the correct forms of 5 words out of the 7 given in the box. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

found cover instead of create impress take place as well as



The Dakar Rally or simply The Dakar is the ultimate off-road race that combines adrenaline thrills and endurance skills in an event that takes place in the breathtaking landscape of the world's most (41) _____ deserts. Riders and drivers of motorcycles, quads, cars and trucks from all over the world take part in an annual race that tests their endurance and racing abilities.

This exciting challenge was the idea of the motorcycle racer, Thierry Sabine, in 1977. He was competing in a race when he got lost in the Tenere Desert and suddenly realized that it would make the perfect location for a rally. He made his dream a reality a year later, in December 1978. He is considered the

(42) _____ and main organizer of the Paris-Dakar, a race starting in Europe and finishing in Africa.

For almost thirty years, competitors raced across the two continents, (43) _____ thousands of miles. Most of the events were from Paris, France to Dakar, Senegal, with the routes often changing. However, in 2008, the race was canceled due to security reasons. Since then, it has been (44) _____ in South America and more specifically in Argentina, Peru, Chile and Bolivia. The name of the race has remained the same.

The Dakar Rally is not a conventional rally, but an off-road race for professionals (45) _____ amateurs. Riders and drivers have to cross tough terrains such as sand dunes, mud, rocks, *etc.* and may have to cover distances of up to 500 – 560 miles per day during the 15-day challenge. It is an extraordinary experience. For participants, reaching the finish line is the challenge of a lifetime.



Section B (5 marks)

*Read the following passage and fill in each blank with **one** word in one of the following **three** ways: according to the context, by using the correct form of the given word, or by using the given letter(s) of the word. Remember to write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

Nowadays, organized tours are a common choice for travellers, and the tourist industry is full of options to cater to every taste. From budget tours for the thrifty traveller to expensive luxury trips around exotic islands, there really is something out there for everyone. However, most of these modern tours are a far cry from the *Grand Tour* that Richard Lassels described in his 1670 book *Voyage to Italy*. He was (46) _____ (refer) to a cultural journey of education that first became popular in the 17th century.



Grand Tours are usually taken by young, wealthy and well-educated men from England who hoped to broaden their horizons and complete their education in culture and arts by travelling to Europe, taking in the sights and gaining first-hand experience. The tours lasted anything (47) _____ a few months up to several years. London was a frequent starting point and Paris a compulsory destination; a trip from Dover across the Channel to Calais and on to Paris normally took three days. The crossing of the Channel was not an easy one. There were risks of (48) _____ (seasick), illness and even shipwreck.

A typical Grand Tourist would arrive in Paris and rent an apartment for several weeks or months. From there they would organize trips to places such as the Palace of Versailles. After staying in Paris, many then travelled to the Netherlands, some to Switzerland and Germany, and a few (49) adv_____ to Spain, Greece, or Turkey. However, the essential place to visit for Grand Tourists was Italy. Rome, Venice and Florence were absolutely not to be missed, with their wealth of cultural delights that could exhaust even the most demanding of travellers.

While on the Tour, the travellers practiced or learned the local language with the help of a guide or a tutor who accompanied them. These tutors were known as bear-leaders. Richard Lassels wrote that on the Grand Tour participants learned about the political, social and economic realities of the world. In other words, it was an experience that

educated travellers on many levels.

The Grand Tour was considered an (50) invaluable experience that led to a dramatic improvement in British architecture and culture.

Part IV Reading Comprehension (30 marks)

*Read the following passages. Each passage is followed by several questions. Respond to the questions using information from the passage. Remember to write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

Section A (10 marks)

Questions 51–55 are based on the following passage.

There are more than 6,500 different languages in the world which all have one thing in common: we use our voices to speak them. What many people are not aware of, however, is that there are some language that do not require speech at all. (51) Less familiar are some other systems of communication found in small communities across the globe, whose origins still remain somewhat of a mystery.



On the Spanish island of La Gomera, off the coast of Africa, there is an unusual language that has been around since before the 15th century. (52) The local landscape, which is hilly and mountainous and covered in mist, may explain why this whistling travels much further than the human voice, so it is an effective way to communicate quickly across valleys or long distances. Also, locals find that it can sometimes be convenient to be able to communicate in a secret way that outsiders cannot understand.

(53) In Turkey there is a village where it is difficult to tell the difference between humans “talking” and birds “tweeting”. At least, most foreigners would say so. It’s called “Kuskoy”, which means “Village of the birds”. Here, like in La Gomera, whistling was beneficial for communicating across mountainous regions and long distances, when telephones and other methods were not available. Even today, when phones are more commonplace, there are people from older generations who still prefer to whistle. They find it much simpler, and, of course, it does not cost anything.

Education in the fine art of whistling begins at an early age with the older generations passing down their skills to the young. It’s not easy of course; in Kuskoy, for example, there are 29 separate whistled noises, one for each letter of the Turkish alphabet. (54) Practice makes perfect and local children pick it up in the end.

In La Gomera, residents, who want to protect their tradition, have gone a step further and made learning whistling compulsory in schools. Unfortunately though, they complain that the everyday use of whistling is becoming rarer as modern technology takes over and younger generations move to towns and cities. (55)



Questions 51–55

Choose from the sentences A–G the one which best fits each gap of 51–55. There are two extra sentences which you do not need to use.

- A. Whistled communities are also found in parts of Greece, Mexico, Turkey and France.
- B. As we know, different countries have different official languages.
- C. Sign language, which uses hand gestures to communicate, is the most well-known of these.
- D. When yelling, the message can travel about 1,600 ft., but it wouldn't be very clear.
- E. As well as talking, people here whistle to communicate.
- F. We will have to wait and see if efforts by locals to protect their unusual culture can survive the many changes of the modern world.
- G. However, it's pretty much like learning to talk.

Section B (10 marks)

Questions 56–60 are based on the following passage.

Ordinarily, when people think of visiting a museum, they don't imagine having to get wet. This isn't the case at Museo Subacuatico de Arte (MUSA), The Museum of Underwater Art in the Caribbean. The museum is located in the National Marine Park off Cancun, Mexico and Isla Mujeres, where visitors not only need to change into a swimsuit but also wear snorkeling (潜水) or scuba diving equipment, because the entire exhibition is underwater.

28 feet beneath the ocean surface, visitors will come face-to-face with life-sized cement statues. The display consists of hundreds of these sculptures, all of which have been modeled on actual **people from all walks of life**. They pose motionless, frozen in their everyday moments. A man stands beside his desk, a woman looks after her pots of seaweed, a girl lies down in a patch of coral reading her book, a couch potato sits watching TV with his remote control.

Although the museum is relatively new, corals have already made the older part of the display their home, as hoped. As time goes by, living organisms settle on the concrete surface that is designed to attract the growth of marine life. Already, tubular worms, jellyfish polyps and starfish have taken root. Eels gracefully swim around the human forms and little reef fish have found small hideouts in order to escape from predators.

The display develops as nature breathes new life into it. The ocean slowly swallows all that is artificial and leaves a living, growing natural reef in its place. It's an ongoing relationship between man and nature that continues as new works are added to the already existing ever-changing display.

The creative force behind the sculptures is English sculptor Jason deCaires Taylor. He has already added *The Archive of Lost Dreams*, *Gardener of Hope* and *Urban Reef* to the display. Recently, with the assistance of underwater helpers, he added *Anthropocene*, an 8-ton cement replica of the classic



Volkswagen Beetle aimed at showing the major impact that people and technology have had on our planet's ecosystem.

Cancun's Ministry of Environment and its Nautical Association asked for the creation of the display as they knew that something had to be done about the serious environmental problem they were facing. The display was aimed at taking people's attention away from the area's natural reefs that had been overfished and damaged by storms and tourism. Officials from Cancun's marine park contacted Jason deCaires Taylor after he had created a small artificial reef near Grenada. Before the project began, marine biologists and underwater experts were consulted. All the statues are made from a special mix of concrete and other materials that prevent from any negative effects on the environment.

Since drawing attention to the artificial reefs, the endangered areas have had the opportunity to regenerate. Meanwhile, Cancun has a new tourist attraction that attracts around 750,000 visitors a year. Mexico has always been famous for its lively crowds, bright colours and lost cultures such as those of the Maya and the Aztecs, but visitors can now also enjoy Mexico for its environmental awareness.

Questions 56–60

Answer the following questions with the information given in the passage.

56. What is unusual about the location of MUSA?
57. What does the writer mean by "people from all walks of life"?
58. What do we learn from the third paragraph about corals?
59. What is the artwork *Anthropocene* aimed to show?
60. What has Mexico always been famous for?

Section C (10 marks)

Questions 61–65 are based on the following passage.

Paper is different from other waste produce because it comes from a sustainable resource: trees. Unlike minerals and oils used to make plastics and metals, trees are replaceable. Paper is also biodegradable, so it doesn't pose as much threat to the environment when it is discarded. While 45 out every 100 tons of wood fiber used to make paper in Australia comes from waste paper; the rest comes directly from virgin fiber from forests and plantations. By world standards this is a good performance since the world-wide average is 33 per cent waste paper. Governments have encouraged waste paper collection and sorting schemes and at the same time, the paper industry has responded by developing new recycling technologies that have paved the way for even greater utilization of used fiber. As a result, industry's use of recycled fibers is expected to increase at twice the rate of virgin fiber over the coming years.

Already, waste paper constitutes 70% of paper used for packaging and advances in the technology required to remove ink from the paper have allowed a higher recycled content in newsprint and writing paper. To achieve the benefits of recycling, the community must also contribute. We need to accept a change in the quality of paper products; for example, stationery may be less white and of a rougher texture. There also needs to be support from the community for waste paper collection programmes. Not only do we need to make the paper available to collectors but it also needs to be separated into different types and sorted from contaminants such as staples, paperclips, string and other miscellaneous (各种各样的) items.

There are technical limitations to the amount of paper which can be recycled and some

paper products cannot be collected for re-use. These include paper in the form of books and permanent records, photographic paper and paper which is badly contaminated. The four most common sources of paper for recycling are factories and retail stores which gather large amounts of packaging material in which goods are delivered, also offices which have unwanted business documents and computer output, paper converters and printers and lastly households which discard newspapers and packaging material. The paper manufacturer pays a price for the paper and may also incur the collection cost.

Once collected, the paper has to be sorted by hand by people trained to recognize various types of paper. This is necessary because some types of paper can only be made from particular kinds of recycled fiber. The sorted paper then has to be mixed with water and broken down into individual fibers. This mixture is called stock and may contain a wide variety of contaminating materials, particularly if it is made from mixed waste paper which has had little sorting. Various kinds of machines are used to remove other materials from the stock. After passing through the repulping process, the fibers from printed waste paper are grey in colour because the printing ink has soaked into the individual fibers. This recycled material can only be used in products where the grey colour doesn't matter, such as cardboard boxes, but if the grey colour isn't acceptable, the fibers must be de-inked. This involves, adding chemicals such as caustic soda, water-hardening agents, frothing agents and bleaching agents. Before the recycled fibers can be made into paper, they must be refined or treated in such a way that they bond together.

Most paper products must contain some virgin fibers as well as recycled fibers, and unlike glass, paper cannot be recycled indefinitely. Most paper is down-cycled, which means that a product made from recycled paper is of an inferior quality to the original paper. Recycling paper is beneficial in that it saves some of the energy, labour and capital that goes into producing virgin pulp. However, recycling requires the use of fossil fuel, a non-renewable energy source, to collect the waste paper from the community and to process it to produce new paper. And the recycling process still creates emissions which require treatment before they can be disposed of safely. Nevertheless, paper recycling is an important economical and environmental practice but one which must be carried out in a rational and viable manner for it to be useful to both industry and the community.

Questions 61–65

Complete the summary below with information from the passage, using no more than three words for each blank.

From the point of view of recycling, paper has two advantages over minerals and oil in that firstly it comes from a resource which is (61) _____ and secondly it's less threatening to our environment when we throw it away because it's (62) _____. Although Australia's record in the reuse of waste paper is good, it's still necessary to use a combination of (63) _____ and virgin fiber to make new paper. The paper industry has contributed positively and people have also been encouraged by the government to collect their waste paper on a regular basis. One major difficulty is the (64) _____ of ink from used paper, but advances are being made in this area. However, we need to learn to accept paper which is generally of a lower quality and to sort our waste paper by removing contaminants before discarding it for (65) _____.

Part V Translation (15 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into Chinese. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

66. Techniques for remembering things like lists, numbers, and facts, are called mnemonic (记忆的) devices. For example, people often use things like poems, pictures, or movements because it is easier to remember rhymes, images, or actions than plain facts and lists. Acronyms (首字母缩略词) are one type of mnemonics. For example, it may be hard to remember the colours of the rainbow in the order that they appear. Someone therefore made an acronym for this: ROY G. BIV. The first letters in the acronym are the first letters in the names for the colours: red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo and violet. The name ROY G. BIV is meaningless, but it's short, so it is easier to remember than the list.



Section B (10 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into English. Write the answer on the **answer sheet**.

67. 几乎每种语言都有丰富的词汇和习惯用语。例如，居住在阿拉斯加和加拿大最北部的因纽特人 (Inuit people) 有许多不同的方式来描述雪。另一方面，爱尔兰人有各种各样的方式来描述绿色景观。在与食物有关的语言中还可以找到其他例子。例如，法语和意大利语有许多谈论葡萄酒的词汇，而美式英语中有很多方式表示牛排应该如何烹饪。由此可见，语言的发展既受环境的影响，也受文化的影响。

Part VI IQ Test (10 marks)

There are **five** IQ Test questions in this part. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

68. Which word continues this sequence?

counterfeit, floundering, encountered, subjoinders

A. viscountess B. dumbfounded C. preannounce

69. In a pet shop there are 5 hutches (笼子) in a row. A different rabbit is in each hutch. Work out, from the clues, where the white rabbit belongs.

1	2	3	4	5
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The black rabbit is next to the white rabbit with red eyes.

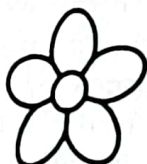
The floppy-eared rabbit is in one of the end hutches.

The fat rabbit is not next to the brown and white rabbit, and it is further to the right than the floppy-eared rabbit.

The brown and white rabbit is between the floppy-eared rabbit and the white rabbit.



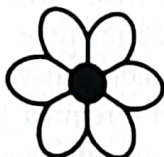
70. Which code matches the pattern given at the end of the line?



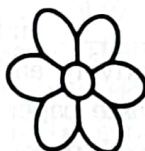
R J



T L



S K



S J



T K



?

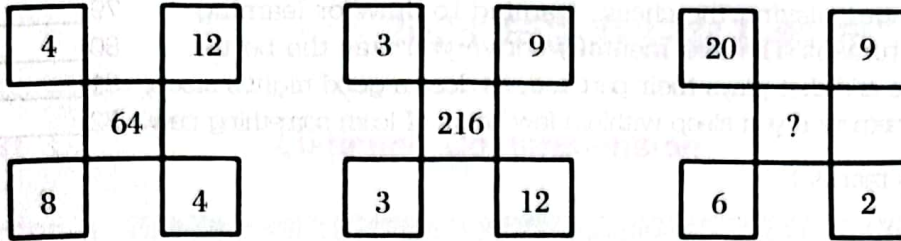
A. SL

B. RK

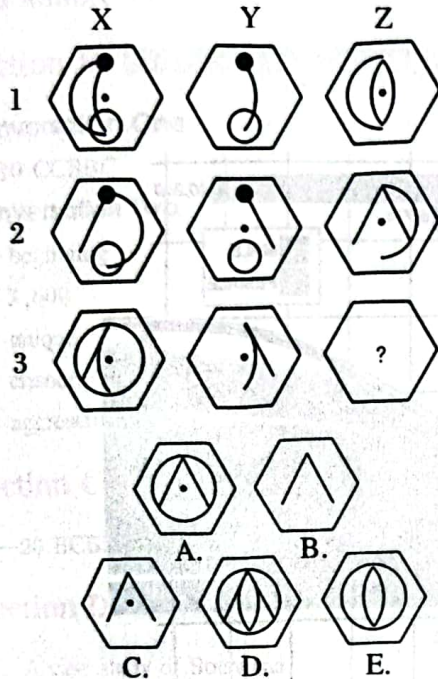
C. RL

D. TJ

71. What number should replace the question mark?



72. Which of the following shape fits the missing space?



What you need to do is to take up a new and challenged activity, such as 78. _____
 learning a new language, playing the chess, learning to draw or learning 79. _____
 to play a musical instrument. The less mentally active you stay the better. 80. _____
 Of course, exercise and diet plays their part too, as does a good night's sleep. 81. _____
 In fact, sleep improves memory if you sleep within a few hours of learn something new. 82. _____

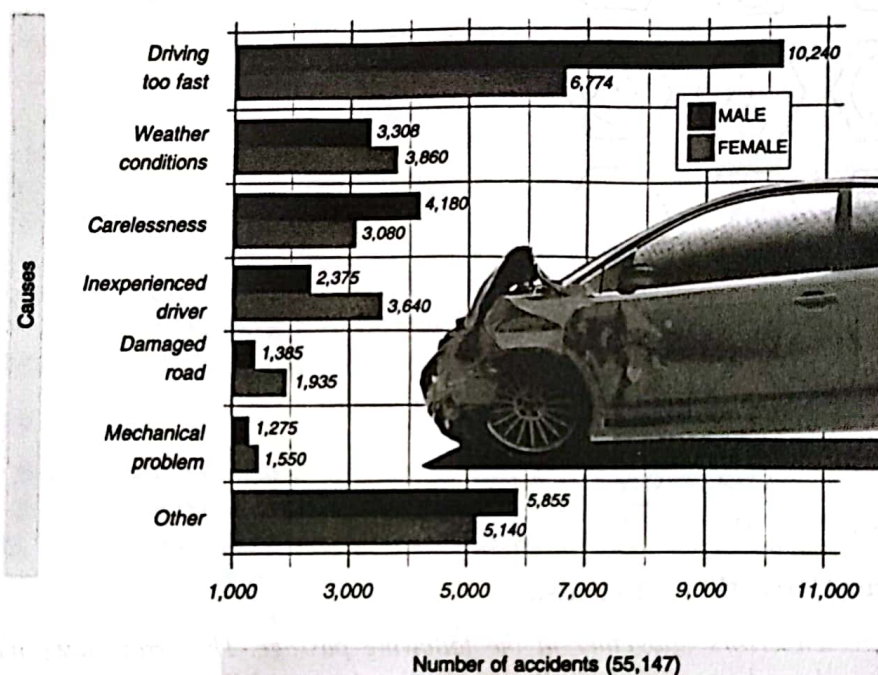
Part VIII Writing (30 marks)

Section A (10 marks)

83.

CAR ACCIDENTS

**according to gender in South Dakota,
U.S.A. (2010–2012)**



Write a report in 80–100 words based on the information given above on the **answer sheet**.

Section B (20 marks)

84. Louis Pasteur, the French scientist said at the beginning of the 19th century: "Chances favour only the prepared mind".



What is your view on this? Write an essay in at least 120 words on the **answer sheet**.